

SPARK User Test Instructions

Research and Writing Activity: Boston Tea Party

Welcome, and thank you for participating in this SPARK user test.

In this activity, you will complete a short research and writing task about the **Boston Tea Party**. As you work, you will use several SPARK functions at different points in the activity.

You do NOT need any previous experience with SPARK.

Purpose of this activity

This activity is designed to see how SPARK fits into a normal workflow. Please complete the task as naturally as possible, as if you were doing a real school or work assignment.

There are no right or wrong answers.

SPARK functions you will use

During this activity, you will use four SPARK functions, and grade them based on rubric provided:

Synthesis

Summarizes your recent workflow based on the windows and pages you have used.

Keyword Search

Finds where an important term appeared in your recent files or pages.

Text Reformatting

Improves the clarity and polish of a paragraph you have written.

Responses

Drafts a short message based on your current context.

Total Estimated Time

Approximately 11–18 minutes

Activity Instructions

Step 1: Research the topic

Estimated time: 5–7 minutes

Research the **Boston Tea Party** using the materials provided.

Please do the following:

1. Open and read a general source on the Boston Tea Party.
2. Open and read one academic source or article excerpt.
3. Open and read one class note or study note related to the topic.
4. Spend a few minutes reviewing the information as you normally would.

Work naturally and pay attention to the main ideas you find important.

Step 2: Use Synthesis

Estimated time: 1-2 minutes

After reviewing the sources, press the **Synthesis** key on SPARK.

Read the output carefully and grade the output based on the provided rubric.

Step 3: Use Keyword Search

Estimated time: 1-2 minutes

Choose one important keyword from your research.

Examples may include:

- taxation
- protest
- British Parliament
- East India Company

Then use the **Keyword Search** function in SPARK. Review the result and grade the output based on the provided rubric.

Step 4: Write a short paragraph

Estimated time: 2-3 minutes

Using what you learned, write a short paragraph about the Boston Tea Party.

Your paragraph should explain:

- what the Boston Tea Party was
- why it was important

Write in your own words. A short paragraph of about 4 to 6 sentences is enough.

Step 5: Use Text Reformatting

Estimated time: 1-2 minutes

After finishing your paragraph, highlight your writing and use the **Text Reformatting** function in SPARK.

Read the revised version and compare it with your original writing. Grade the output based on the provided rubric.

Step 6: Use Responses

Estimated time: 1-2 minutes

Now imagine you want to send a short Slack update to a classmate or teammate about what you worked on and what you learned.

Use the **Responses** function in SPARK to generate a short message. Grade the output based on the provided rubric.

Participant ID	Writing Length Preference	Writing Confidence	Workflow Style	Best Feature	Least Helpful Feature	Key Observation
P1						

Feature	Score	Notes
Synthesis		
Keyword Search		
Text Reformatting		
Responses		